

What the Evidence Does and Does Not Show

The evidence identifies a **language pattern**, not its cause.

WHAT IT SHOWS

A readable pattern

CEO Q&A uncertainty tracks the point when an acquisition moves from private to public.

A within-firm regularity around disclosure - no more, and no less.

WHAT IT DOES NOT SHOW - AND WHERE IT MAY NOT CARRY

01	Cause and effect	The design is descriptive, not causal . It characterizes a within-firm regularity.
02	Generalizability	The sample skews toward larger, more heavily covered U.S. public firms (approximately the S&P 1500, 2002-2018), limiting generalizability.
03	A direct reading of the CEO	The finance-specific word count is an imperfect proxy that abstracts from context; it does not read the CEO's mind.
04	A perfect comparison	Stock deals share the disclosure setting, but remain an imperfect comparison for cash deals.